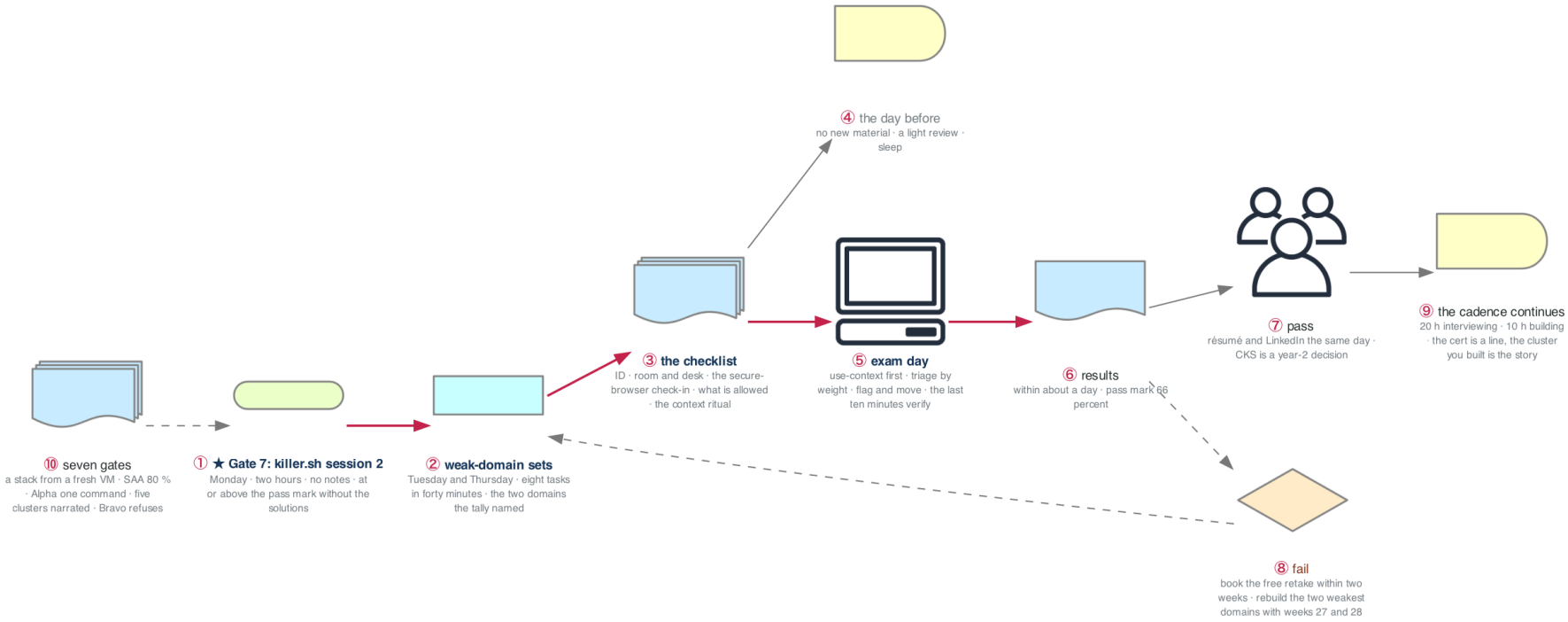
Exam week: the second simulator session is the gate, numbered

Week 30 · Figure 30.1 · figure with badges 1–10 · 2026-10-25



What to say, badge by badge

About three minutes at a normal pace (484 words). Point at each badge as you say its line.

Open
“This is the week the module was for. Monday's simulator session is the gate: at or above the pass mark, inside two hours, without opening a solution. Pass it and the exam is a formality with a clock; miss it and the week still runs, because the exam is booked and the retake is free.”

1 **Gate 7**
“The second killer.sh session, Monday, run exactly like the exam: two hours, no notes, the solutions closed. The pass mark is sixty-six percent. The score is written in the progress file with the domain of every miss, and it is the last number the program records.”

2 **weak-domain sets**
“Tuesday and Thursday: eight tasks in forty minutes, built for the two domains the tally named. Nothing else is drilled. A domain you are already fast in does not get faster in two days.”

3 **the checklist**
“A government ID that matches the registration name, a clear desk and a room you can show on camera, the secure browser installed and tested the day before, nothing on the desk but what is allowed, and the context ritual written on nothing because you will not have paper.”

4 **the day before**
“No new material; it displaces what is already loaded. A light pass over the ritual and the first commands, then sleep. Cramming the night before measurably lowers scores, and this exam is already timed against you.”

5 **exam day**
“Set the aliases in the first minute. Every task: switch context, verify, read to the end, do it, verify. Take the cheap tasks first, give the rest two minutes before you flag them, and spend the last ten minutes verifying flagged work rather than starting new work.”

6 **results**
“Within about a day. Either way the next badge applies, and either way you keep interviewing this week.”

7 **pass**
“Update the résumé and the LinkedIn headline the same day, with a sentence about the cluster you built rather than the badge. The CKS is a year-two decision, after real operating experience; it is not next.”

8 **fail**
“The package includes one free retake. Book it within two weeks while the material is loaded, and spend the gap rebuilding the two weakest domains with weeks 27 and 28, not re-reading. A fail costs a fortnight; quitting costs the module.”

9 **the cadence continues**
“Twenty hours interviewing, ten building, the same loop as week 26. The certificate is a line on a page that gets past a filter; the kubeadm cluster, the etcd restore and the upgrade are the stories you tell once you are in the room.”

10 **seven gates**
“A stack from a fresh VM, the SAA at eighty percent, Alpha in one command, five broken clusters narrated, Bravo refusing a CVE and an unsigned image, Charlie in ten minutes, and the simulator at the pass mark. Seven proofs; the seventh is the one hiring managers filter on.”

Close
“Gate, drills, checklist, rest, exam, result. Then back to the cadence that converts. The program ended at week 26; the module ends here; neither one was the finish line.”